

growing segments. In 2020, the television market size stood at ₹77,800 crore (\$10.66 billion) and is estimated to stand at ₹76,900 crore (\$10.53 billion) by 2022. India's television industry still has 120 million paying subscribers including cable, and players such as Tata Play are banking on nearly half of those who pay for cable TV to upgrade to pay TV at some point. "TV is not a written off industry. It's our bread and butter. TV and OTT are the two industries that will grow. That's why we're distributors of both," says Nagpal.

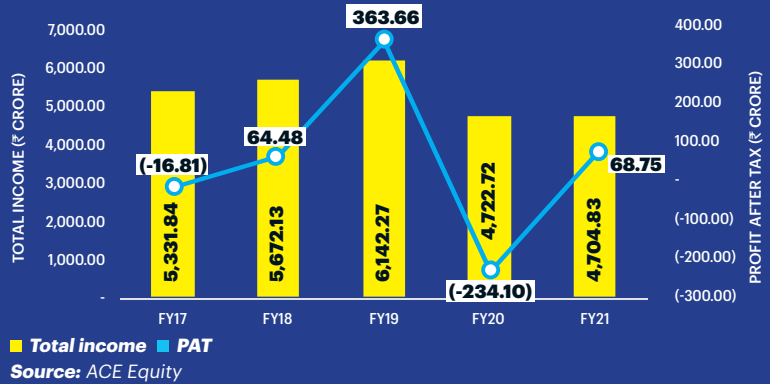
According to a recent report by CII-BCG, India grew to 70-80 million paid subscribers of OTT platforms at the end of 2021 from just 0.5 million in 2014-15. During the pandemic, OTT became the online avenue for new movie releases and the industry has seen a 4x jump in the number of OTT services in the past six years.

Seeing the massive growth potential of the OTT industry, Tata Play, which is known to be one of the first to introduce innovations like Hindi language EPG (electronic programme guide), DVRs, HD STBs (set-top boxes), etc., sees a customer need while growing its current business as a result of the spillover from Free Dish and cable TV users. "Our differentiation is not on pricing but on process. We won't throw apps at people. When people sit down to watch TV, they don't watch to watch Hotstar, or Zee5 or [Amazon] Prime [Video]. They're looking for content in a particular genre or a show that everybody's talking about," says Nagpal.

Tata Play took two years to build a front end that allows users to differentiate based on tastes rather than platforms. Nagpal is targeting this new offering towards families. "The household subscribes for TV like it subscribes to electricity. Now, when one person has started

CHOPPY NUMBERS

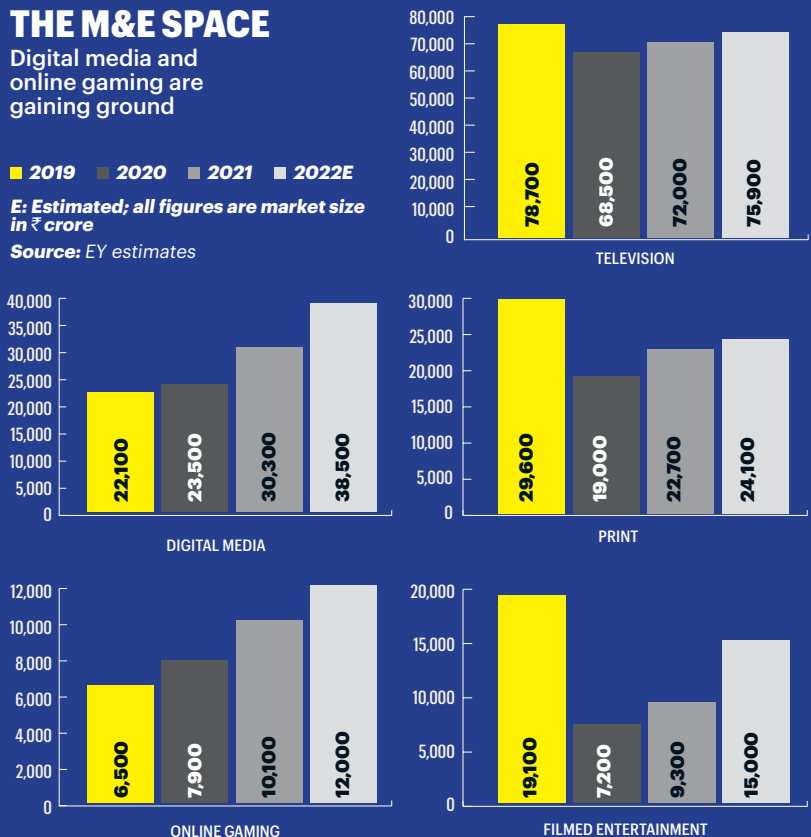
Both income and profits have been erratic for Tata Play



THE M&E SPACE

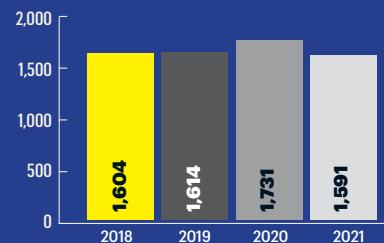
Digital media and online gaming are gaining ground

E: Estimated; all figures are market size in ₹ crore
Source: EY estimates



TRACKING TELEVISION TIME

Time spent on TV decreased 8 per cent in 2021 over 2020



THE AUDIENCE MIX

The number of television subscriptions in million

